Current-State Assessment

Warehouse Management & Procurement System Replacement Initiative

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Project: Legacy WMS / Procurement Replacement ('Project Horizon')

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1. Purpose of This Document

This document captures the current-state operating environment at Meridian Manufacturing & Logistics ahead of the selection of a replacement Warehouse Management System (WMS) and procurement platform. It consolidates findings from stakeholder interviews across Operations, Finance, Warehouse, Procurement, and IT, and translates them into a structured pain-point catalog that will feed the business case, RFP requirements, and evaluation criteria in later stages of this project.

2. Background

Meridian operates two manufacturing plants and three regional distribution warehouses. Inventory, put-away, picking, and procurement are currently managed on 'LogiTrack Classic', an on-premise system implemented in 2011. The system runs on unsupported infrastructure, has no vendor-supplied patches since 2021, and lacks native integration with Meridian's finance system (Tally-based ledgers reconciled manually). Leadership has approved a project to assess, select, and implement a replacement platform, and has assigned a Business Analyst to lead requirements gathering and vendor evaluation.

3. Stakeholder Interview Notes

Interviews were conducted with five stakeholders representing the primary user groups and decision-influencers for this initiative. Notes below are summarized from 45–60 minute structured interviews; direct quotes are paraphrased for clarity.

Rajiv Malhotra — Head of Operations

Interview focus: Cross-plant visibility, KPIs, executive reporting

- Has no single view of stock across the three warehouses — relies on a weekly manual consolidation done in Excel by three different warehouse admins, each with their own template.
- Monthly close is delayed by 3-4 days because inventory valuation from LogiTrack Classic does not tie back cleanly to Finance's ledger.
- Wants real-time dashboards for fill rate, stock-outs, and dead stock, currently only available as a manual monthly report.
- Flagged that any new system must support role-based access, since the current system gives all warehouse staff edit access to all records, which has caused data integrity issues twice in the last year.

Sunita Rao — Finance Controller

Interview focus: Cost control, audit trail, reconciliation

- Manual reconciliation between LogiTrack Classic and Tally consumes roughly 25 finance-team hours per month.
- No audit trail on inventory adjustments — the system allows silent overwrites of quantity fields with no change log, which is a recurring internal-audit finding.
- Needs the new system to support landed-cost calculation for imported raw materials, which LogiTrack Classic cannot do at all today (handled in a separate spreadsheet).
- Budget appetite exists for a mid-market solution but she flagged that any multi-year licensing commitment needs a clear payback-period justification for the CFO.

Deepak Yadav — Warehouse Supervisor, Bhiwadi DC

Interview focus: Day-to-day picking, put-away, and floor operations

- Barcode scanning is not supported; all put-away and picking is recorded on paper and entered into the system at end of shift, causing same-day stock counts to be unreliable.
- System frequently times out during peak dispatch hours (system was sized for a much smaller SKU base than Meridian now carries).
- Wants mobile/handheld device support for pickers — currently a fully manual, paper-driven process.
- Training new warehouse staff on the current system takes 2+ weeks because the UI is unintuitive and undocumented.

Priya Nair — Procurement Manager

Interview focus: Purchase requisitions, vendor management, PO approvals

- Purchase requisitions are raised via email and tracked in a shared spreadsheet — no formal PR-to-PO workflow or approval matrix exists in the current system.
- No visibility into vendor delivery performance or price history; renegotiations rely on institutional memory rather than data.
- Wants three-way matching (PO, GRN, invoice) to reduce the manual invoice-verification effort currently done line-by-line.
- Flagged that any new system needs configurable approval thresholds, since procurement policy varies by plant and by spend category.

Arvind Kapoor — IT Manager

Interview focus: Infrastructure, integration, support, security

- LogiTrack Classic runs on a single on-prem server with no failover; last unplanned outage lasted 14 hours during a peak dispatch week.
- Vendor for LogiTrack Classic no longer offers a support contract; internal IT has been reverse-engineering fixes for two years.
- Strong preference for a cloud or hybrid solution with a documented API for integration with Tally and, eventually, a planned ERP rollout.
- Security review is a hard gate — needs SSO/role-based access control and a data-residency answer before any vendor can proceed past shortlist.

4. Pain-Point Catalog

Findings from the five interviews were consolidated and de-duplicated into the pain-point catalog below. Severity was assigned jointly with Operations and IT leadership based on frequency of occurrence and downstream business impact. This catalog is the direct input to the business case (Section 5 of the project plan) and to the RFP's functional requirements.

ID	Area	Pain Point	Severity	Business Impact
PP-01	Operations	No consolidated cross-warehouse stock visibility; manual weekly Excel roll-up	High	Delayed decisions, stock-out/overstock risk
PP-02	Finance	No audit trail on inventory adjustments; silent overwrites possible	High	Audit findings, compliance exposure
PP-03	Finance	Manual reconciliation between WMS and Tally (~25 hrs/month)	Medium	Delayed month-end close, labor cost
PP-04	Warehouse	No barcode/handheld support; paper-based picking and put-away	High	Inventory accuracy, throughput
PP-05	Warehouse	System performance degrades / times out during peak dispatch	High	Missed dispatch SLAs
PP-06	Procurement	No formal PR-to-PO workflow; tracked via email and spreadsheet	Medium	Approval delays, no spend visibility
PP-07	Procurement	No three-way matching; manual line-by-line invoice verification	Medium	Invoice processing time, error risk
PP-08	IT	Single point of failure infrastructure; vendor support discontinued	High	Business continuity risk
PP-09	IT	No SSO / granular role-based access control	Medium	Security and compliance risk
PP-10	Finance	No landed-cost calculation for imported raw materials	Low	Manual spreadsheet workaround, costing accuracy

5. Summary of Current-State Themes

- Data integrity & auditability — multiple stakeholders independently raised the lack of change history / audit trail as a top concern.
- Manual, paper-driven floor operations — the absence of barcode/handheld scanning is the single largest driver of both inventory inaccuracy and picker inefficiency.
- No procurement workflow — purchasing operates almost entirely outside the system of record today, via email and spreadsheets.
- Infrastructure and support risk — the current platform is a discontinued product on unsupported infrastructure, making this a business-continuity issue as much as a productivity one.
- Cross-functional reconciliation overhead — Finance and Operations both lose significant time reconciling data that should be a single source of truth.

6. Next Steps

- Translate this pain-point catalog into weighted functional and non-functional requirements for the RFP (Document 3).
- Use severity and business impact ratings as inputs to the cost-benefit analysis and business case (Document 2).
- Validate this current-state summary with stakeholders before RFP issuance.